Settlements Version 2

Tests and turns

Core tests

Ordinary: d20 + stat + modifiers − Stress; **15+ passes**. Natural 1 fails; natural 20 passes. Trivial safe tasks are automatic. Difficult or dangerous tasks use the same test; impossible tasks need another approach.

Modifiers: use the largest positive and negative skill bonus (each capped at 4), and largest positive and negative equipment-characteristic bonus (each capped at 3). Then apply position once: light cover −1, heavy cover −2, legal Hidden target −4, rear +2, Aim +2; against Pinned, ranged −2 / melee +2. Pinned stacks with applicable cover; hit rolls only. Printed Damage and Armour are profile values. Identical effects never stack; reroll a die once at most.

Single opposed test: both roll stat tests; higher wins, ties defend. Natural 20 beats non-20; natural 1 loses to non-1; matching natural extremes tie. Melee pools use Page 2 instead.

Stress exceptions: never subtract Stress from Injury, Break, Rally, initiative, distance or post-battle tables.

Start and alternating activations

Play six rounds. At Start, restore Move and Core to conscious and Down fighters, clear Activated/Reacted, reset round abilities; READY persists. Unconscious/captured fighters get no usable slots. Roll initiative; high chooses first, ties favour last round's second player (reroll round-1 tie).

At Start, fewer eligible fighters grants Passes equal to that difference; Down counts, Unconscious/captured do not. Alternate whole-fighter activations: mark Activated, resolve one Move and one Core in either order, then opponent activates. Each action allows reactions. Forfeit unused slots; no reactivation. Both-cost actions use both slots. Passing without a Pass forfeits remaining activations.

One own-turn attack per fighter per round: Shoot, Fight or Charge. One reaction is separate. Defensive melee is separate. Shove, Grapple, Throw, Incapacitate, damaging grenades and directing turret fire also use the own-attack allowance.

Action costs

Move slot: travel up to MOVE, crawl half MOVE while Pinned, or Recover: stand up in place, removing Pinned. Standing uses Move and leaves Core available in this activation. Never convert Move to Core.

Both slots: Dash up to 2 × MOVE; Charge MOVE + d6 then melee; Disengage.

Core slot: Shoot, Fight/Shove, Ready, Aim, Help Recover, Rally, Hide, Observe, Interact/Hack, Deploy, Repair, Treat/Use Item, Loot, Secure, Reload. One Core only; skills cannot convert Move into another Core.

Aim: +2 to next Shoot, including a reaction; expires end of next round. Lost on movement/standing, Pinned or engagement. Apply to whole shot, then remove; never stacks.

READY and reactions

Ready costs Core. One token maximum. Lose it for voluntary movement, any regular action other than Ready, a hit, Down, Unconscious, capture or a morale condition.

React only while conscious, unengaged, READY, not Reacted and without a morale condition. Need front LOS and action range. One reacting model per enemy action, including an entire Charge. Declare at the start, a precise visible movement point, or the end. Spend READY and mark Reacted. No reaction chains.

Shoot: normal shot before a non-shooting action or at the chosen movement point. A hit that Pins/Downs cancels unfinished action; spent slots/items remain spent.

Return Fire: when the enemy shoots you, shoot simultaneously using ordinary 15+ tests. Resolve both from declaration states, then apply outcomes. Neither shot cancels the other. Cover Me extends this to protecting a nearby friendly.

Dive: before incoming Shoot/Charge dice, test AGI. Pass: move up to 3 inches and become Pinned. Fail: stay and become Pinned. Recheck attack legality. Pinned may only Dive if it retained READY by a specific rule.

Operate: operate a reachable control/terminal before the trigger finishes. **Interrupt:** requires its skill. Return Fire, Dive and Cover Me must be declared before attack dice; no retroactive reactions.

End Phase

Resolve due end effects; expire Down at recorded round +2; resolve one Break/Rally per eligible fighter; score objectives; clear round effects and Passes; expire dated Aim and hazards. End after round 6 or the mission ending.

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Position combat and injury

Facing and movement

Front **180 degrees** provides LOS; boundary counts as front. Free facing during own movement or at start of own Core, never in response to an enemy declaration. Rear attack: +2 hit. Human sight uses an agreed 2-inch body cylinder; ignore decorative pose. Standing bodies block LOS. Pinned/Down/Unconscious require their **base footprint** to be visible and see from ground level.

Ordinary Move cannot enter within 1 inch of a conscious enemy, including Pinned. Down/Unconscious do not block movement or LOS. Premeasure. Light/heavy cover requires actual obscuration and target within 1 inch of it or inside its area. Use strongest only. Low cover within 1 inch of shooter is ignored. Height grants sight, not a bonus.

Low obstacle ≤1 inch costs 2 inches to cross. Difficult ground, Pinned, Hidden and heavy carrying halve movement **once**, never repeatedly. Unlocked ordinary doors open during Move; closing costs Interact.

Charge: visible target, legal route, within MOVE +6. Spend Both, roll d6. Reach engagement with MOVE + die: melee, +1 dominant die within pool cap. Fail: Move up to MOVE toward target, stop outside engagement, no attack. Failed traversal or pinning reaction stops it.

Climb: stairs/ladders measured, no test. Free climb needs handholds/gear, costs double height and AGI. Fail: remain at start; natural 1 falls from halfway. **Jump:** ≤1 inch automatic; >1 to 3 inches AGI with enough movement; fail falls. Wider needs another route.

Fall/drop: deliberate ≤2 inches safe. Greater drop/fall: AGI; pass Pinned, fail Damage 3 Injury ignoring Armour, then Pinned if conscious. Over 6 inches automatically fails AGI. Inaccessible casualty: mark rim, Unconscious, recover post-battle.

Carry/escort: half MOVE, one hand, no Dash/Charge. Two helpers may spend both Move slots as one action to carry at the slower normal MOVE. Either being Pinned/Down stops them and releases the load.

Shooting

Forward LOS and weapon range. Roll each die: **d20 + DEX + modifiers − Stress ≥15** hits. Natural 1 misses, 20 hits. No generic range/move penalty. In an engagement, a natural 1 hits one involved friendly chosen by opponent; ignore that rule for Blast.

Dual one-handed weapons: dominant pool plus one off-hand die; keep its weapon identity. **Maximum three dice** including Charge/skills. Both must be usable and held. Weapon slots match two hands: one-handed uses one, two-handed/Heavy uses both. No legal melee weapon: one unarmed die, Damage 0. A Sidearm contributes one STR-based melee die. Choose held weapons before first action/reaction; one later switch on own action, never retroactively.

Melee

Choose one engaged enemy. Both roll held melee pools plus STR (AGI for Agile), modifiers and −Stress; **+2 per die against Pinned**. Each die **above the enemy's highest total** hits. Equal maxima: no hits. Natural 1 excluded from attack and defence; natural 20 uses its modified total. Against all 1s, every non-1 hits. Defender always has at least one die unless incapacitated.

Outnumbered: −1 per additional conscious unpinned engaging enemy, max −2. **Unanswered:** defender sets maximum but cannot score hits. A Charge wholly through the rear arc is Unanswered with +2 hit. Both may face each other after melee.

Shove: replace Fight with opposed STR; pass pushes 2 inches and Pins, fail no effect. **Disengage:** Both, opposed AGI against one opponent. Pass MOVE; fail enemy makes one Unanswered exchange, then survivor moves half MOVE. Pinned never exceeds half MOVE. Forced flight permits one such escape attack, then movement. An engaged Move may instead shift 1 inch while staying engaged.

Hits and casualties

Each hit: **d20 + Damage − Armour + injury modifiers ≥15**. Natural 1 fails, 20 succeeds; no Stress penalty. Success removes the human's **one Wound: Down**. Failure gives 1 Stress. Any hit leaving a Wound also Pins. Resolve the pool together; surplus successes do not execute or multiply post-battle rolls.

Pinned: ranged hits against it −2; melee hits +2. Stay down until you choose to act. Move can crawl half speed or stand in place (Recover); standing removes Pinned, not Stress/morale, and counts as movement for Aim/Unwieldy. Unused Core remains available in this activation. Self-Rally/Disengage allowed; no voluntary attack/Ready/equipment use while Pinned. A capable helper within 3 inches/LOS spends Core on automatic Help Recover.

Settlements Version 2

Casualties morale and interaction

Down and rescue

Down stays on table, drops mission cargo, loses READY/Hidden/Marked/Aim, retains Stress. Record the round. Only crawl half MOVE or self-Treat with an available slot. No objective control/contest. At End of **Down round +2**, become Unconscious: no actions or revival, still lootable/carryable. Down in round 2 expires at End of round 4.

Treat: Core, contact, medkit consumed, INT test. Helper must be conscious, unpinned and unengaged. Success: 1 Wound, Pinned, Stress 2, remove morale condition. Self-treatment ignores Stress. Failure consumes kit but does not change timer. One successful revival per fighter per battle. Slots do not refresh.

Loot: Core/contact takes one item, including armour, into free capacity. Drop gear to make room. **Secure:** Core/contact Down or Unconscious enemy; no conscious unpinned enemy within 1 inch of either. Captive cannot act; its timer runs. Escort half MOVE off own deployment edge to complete capture. Escort Pinned/Down/fear releases it. Friendly evacuation needs no Secure. An extracting escort/carrier also leaves the battle. Evacuated casualties still roll injury.

Attacking Down: normal shot or contact Core for one automatic hit. Injury success makes Unconscious. No on-table death or further effect against Unconscious.

Stress and fear

Stress maximum **5**. Failed Injury: +1 each. First friendly Down seen within 6 inches each round: +1, using front LOS; no witness Stress while Down/Unconscious. Pinning adds none separately.

End Phase, conscious with 2+ Stress and no morale condition: **Break = d20 + NRV + modifiers ≥15**, ignoring Stress. Pass clears Stress. Fail: 1–2 Broken; 3–4 Bolting; 5 Bugging Out. Natural 1/20 apply. Normal Break never occurs at 0–1; a forced failure at 0 uses Broken.

Broken: Pinned; only Move, Recover, self-Rally, Disengage. **Bolting:** activation spends remaining slots moving up to 2 × MOVE toward nearest reachable safe place outside enemy LOS; prefer heavy cover. **Bugging Out:** same toward nearest reachable board edge; reaching it leaves play. Forced movement overrides Pinned but not terrain; once per round. None may react, assist, score or contest.

Already afraid at start of End Phase: **Rally instead of Break**. Same Stress-free test; success clears morale, Stress and Pinned. Failure keeps condition; never Break then Rally immediately. Core self-Rally allowed except while Bolting/Bugging Out. A capable friendly within 3 inches and LOS may Rally you with its NRV. Also clears ordinary Stress on success.

At start of your turn, crew withdrawal ends battle, opponent wins; uncaptured survivors return. Carried gear returns; mission extraction rewards need an actual exit. Unextracted captives are released. No free enemy cleanup.

Hidden and observation

Hide Core in cover or fully unseen, never within 3 inches and LOS of an enemy. Fully unseen automatic; otherwise AGI. Positions stay public. Hidden halves Move. Attack, loud operation, engagement or a hit reveals; Charge removes it when movement begins. Quiet/skills give specific exceptions.

Enemy within 3 inches with LOS reveals immediately. At own action start/end, enemy LOS within 12 inches without cover reveals. Hidden target beyond 12 cannot be attacked; within 12 and visible, −4 hit plus cover. Blast ignores Hidden penalty. Observe Core/INT, one Hidden enemy or concealed device within 12 inches/LOS; success reveals. Mark Target must first have a legal target, never grants sight through walls.

Interact and Hack

Core/contact for one operation. Safe trivial task automatic; force STR, fine work DEX, technical INT. Occupied dangerous operation needs operator test before hazard. Failure normally changes nothing. Agree improvised object, cost, effect and failure first; reuse printed operations and plausible human limits.

Terminal: up to three declared feature links within 12 inches, no chaining. Core/contact INT Hack operates one linked feature; natural 1 Freezes terminal to End Phase. Manual controls remain. Shared linked feature means same network for Interrupt only.

Hacking kit: Core/INT at visible electronic device within 8 inches; success Offline until Repair; natural 1 also stops kit use this round. No hacking humans/guns. Repair Core/contact INT restores Offline, never Destroyed. Mission-critical terrain cannot be shot away.

Settlements Version 2

Terrain devices and objectives

Shared terrain procedures

Feature card: footprint, controls, links, states, operation, hazard. Paper markers work. **Displace:** shortest safe position up to 2 inches, owner chooses; no space means operation stops unless Crush. **Crush:** conscious victim AGI; pass Displace, fail/no space Damage 3 Injury ignoring Armour, then Pinned if conscious. Casualties cannot evade; Down may become Unconscious, never Dead. One Crush per feature per fighter per round.

Smoke: 3-inch diameter, blocks through LOS up to 3 inches above surface; inside visibility only 1 inch. Gas: 3-inch Difficult zone, +1 Stress on entry/action start, once per round; respirator ignores. Fire: 3-inch zone, Damage 2 Injury on entry/action start once per round; no LOS block. INT/Core at edge extinguishes, extinguisher automatic. Portable smoke/fire expire End of next round; fixed vents remain while On.

Doors/shutters open or close; blast door may Crush. Lift ≤6 inches between stops. Bridge ≤6 inches retracts: AGI to safe end within 2 inches or Fall. Pit cover same escape. Crane/hoist move marked cargo ≤4 inches, Crush only in declared area. Moving barricade Displaces, never pushes off ledge. Lights reveal Hidden in 6-inch-diameter zone. Fans clear linked smoke/gas. Junction disables up to two linked features within 12 inches; manual routes remain. Use the chosen card for other features.

Devices and drones

Deploy Core/contact: physical cover/ladder automatic; armed or electronic device INT. Failure inert; retry Core. Cannot trigger on models already inside when armed, but later movement can. Location public; type may be concealed until triggered, Observed, or approached within 2 inches/LOS. DEX/Core/contact disarms; natural 1 triggers. Electronic device may be hacked instead.

Both crews trigger mines/traps. Tripwire crossing/remote clamp within 1 inch: AGI or stop Pinned, consumed either way. Blast mine triggers within 2 inches/LOS, shared 2-inch-radius Crush. Turret: DEX 2, one die, Damage 2, range 12, front 180; READY each Start, first round after deployment; one attack per round, consuming READY whether operated or reacting.

Devices have no Injury, Stress, morale or scoring: first hit Offline, next Destroyed; mine/trap hit ruined safely. Drone first hit Destroyed. Physical barricades cannot be shot away. Recover an inert item or wreck with Interact and free capacity.

Drone: Core deploys. Later operator Core: fly 8 inches, operate drone-contact control/terminal, or Observe within drone LOS/12 inches. One command per Core; operator retains Move. Control range 12 inches; height ≤6 inches; camera 360. Use operator INT/Stress. Incapable operator means inert drone. One reaction window targets visible operator or drone; disabling either stops the command. No drone attack, READY, Claim, cargo, capture or independent actions.

Special attacks and supplies

Blast: visible point in weapon range, **2-inch radius**. One ordinary Attack Die per affected fighter/device with unobstructed blast line, on same level or within 2 inches vertically; solid floors/walls block. Cover from centre; −2 against Pinned; ignore Hidden. No scatter/extra central hit; no bonus dice or dual use.

Smoke grenade: Core/DEX, visible point within 8 inches. Pass place; fail 2 inches closer along line, stopping at obstruction. Fire bottle: ordinary Damage 1 Blast, then fire zone; initial attack counts as that round's fire exposure. Damaging grenades use Core Shoot and the attack allowance; smoke uses Core Use Item. Grenades consume their item. Reload weapons start loaded, need Core reload after firing. One chem dose per fighter per round; Pinned needs a helper. Use printed roster entries for other traits/items.

Objectives and battle end

Eligible controller: conscious, unpinned, unengaged human, no morale condition, within 2 inches; any eligible enemy contests. Extra bodies do not outweigh one opponent. **Claim:** Core/contact uncontested, ownership persists after leaving until opponent Claims; contested claim scores nothing. **Retrieve:** Core/contact take cargo, one per fighter; Heavy halves Move/occupies hand, no Dash/Charge. Pass to contact friendly costs giver Core. **Work:** Core/contact, appropriate normal test; default two cumulative successes, failed action loses no progress.

Choose primary plus one public secondary per crew. Default primary: three Control/Claim markers score 1 each from End round 2, max 2/crew/round; or three Retrieve cargo score 2 extracted/1 held at end; or two Work panels, 2 points each crew per completed panel. Secondary 2 points once: operate two useful features outside own zone, record reconnaissance with Core in enemy zone, extract secondary supply, or rescue own casualty. No kill points. See manuscript for placement.

End round 6: highest score wins, tie draws; withdrawal loses. Resolve injury once for each unresolved Down/Unconscious, update actual loot, then Settlement round. Both crews receive 125 Credits/20 Materials, winner +25 Credits. Qualifying battle needs two complete rounds or normal early mission completion. Use manuscript Chapters 18–21 for injuries, XP, workers and Power.